

## Baylor Eswatini\_Eswatini\_2025-26\_3-Month Report

Fellowship Organization

Baylor Eswatini

Fellowship City

Mbabane

Fellowship Country

Eswatini

Fellowship Start Date

8/11/2025

Anticipated End Date

8/11/2026

What kind of visa/ permit do you have or applied for?

I have a one-year work permit with the Government of Eswatini.

How did you obtain (or are obtaining) your visa or permit?

Baylor handled the process for me. It was a lengthy process that required a lot of documentation and had a long wait time before approval.

Did you apply for and receive your visa or permit before going to your host country or after arriving?

I had to wait for my work permit to be approved before entering Eswatini. Once it was approved, I booked my flight and traveled here.

What costs were associated with obtaining your visa or permit?

I paid roughly \$100 for a fingerprint background check and around \$40 for notary services.

Did you pay the visa / permit costs or were they covered by your organization?

Baylor covered the main visa and permit costs. I only paid for the fingerprint background check and notary services necessary for the application.

Are you still having challenges obtaining your visa/ permit?

Yes

If yes, please explain further

The work permit process took nearly three months to get approved, which delayed my travel and made the flight much more expensive since I couldn't book until the permit was finalized and had to purchase the ticket just a few days before leaving. Baylor also required a copy of my university diploma, which I didn't have yet since I had just graduated, so I had to work through several alternatives to meet that requirement.

Do you have any suggestions to help future Fellows navigate the visa / permit application process?

Start the process as early as possible—it can take a long time to get approved. Make sure you're getting the correct type of fingerprint and background check required for the permit.

What vaccinations were you required to obtain prior to your departure?

How was your arrival and first week in your host country?